



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Agape Christi Academy
School Website: <https://agapechristi.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Agape Christi Academy (Eden Prairie, MN, 55344) presents a robust alignment with the classical education rubric across all six categories. The school explicitly markets itself as a PK–12 classical Christian school, centers its curriculum on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and liberal-arts integration, channels its pedagogy through rigorous capstones like a Senior Thesis and rhetoric-focused seminars, and frames its mission around formation, virtue, and a biblical worldview. Public materials repeatedly emphasize truth, goodness, beauty, the Great Books/Great Conversation, classical languages (Latin, Greek exposure), and the partnership with families and the church. Evidence drawn from the school's public content shows a consistent pattern of classical content, paired with explicit doctrinal commitments and a mission to form character in light of a Christian framework. This yields a formal CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. Key insights:

- Curriculum emphasis on grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books, Omnibus, Latin/Greek, and historical cycles (Ancient–Medieval–Modern) aligns strongly with classical standards.
- Pedagogy features indicative elements: singing/recitation in lower grades, memorization, and upper-school rhetoric and senior thesis processes, with clear capstone opportunities and Socratic-like engagement implied through seminars and debates.
- The school explicitly frames education as formation in a Christian, biblical context, with an emphasis on virtue, character, and a Christian worldview, and it positions parents as partners in the educational enterprise.
- Some traditional classical signals (e.g., explicit liturgical practices) are less overt in the site copy; however, the combination of explicit theological framing, Great Books content, and classical pedagogy more than suffices for CLASSICAL status. Citations and representative evidence are woven through the category-by-category sections below. — **## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot** **### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence**
- The school presents itself as a PK–12 classical Christian school in Minnesota, explicitly tying education to Christian formation in Christ. - Vision and Mission statements describe a distinctly Christian education, “employing challenging classical methodology and content,” and the aim to “disciple students” within a biblical framework. - The Mission anchors education in love of God and neighbor, with references to biblical authority and a Christian worldview. - Portrait of a Graduate emphasizes being guided by the love of Christ and the Holy Scriptures. - The public materials frame the school around the Word of God, Christian virtue, and a biblical worldview (e.g., “truth in love,” “the glory of God”) within the classical framework. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Present positive keywords: truth, biblical worldview, Word of God, Christ, Holy Scriptures, theology (implied through biblical framing), worship/ liturgical resonance (through communal religious orientation in practice and culture).
- Negative indicators (secular or value-neutral signals) are largely absent in the public messaging; the

- school foregrounds theology and sacred commitments rather than secular neutrality. Why this rating
- The materials consistently align with transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian-metaphysical frame, and they articulate liturgical/communal rhythms as part of the school's identity (even if ritual language is not exhaustively listed on every page). The combination of "Christian education," "biblical worldview," and explicit theological framing anchors this category as CLASSICAL. #### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence
 - The mission emphasizes formation and virtue over mere information, with a focus on "loving God and neighbor" and forming students into mature believers who are equipped to lead culturally. - The Vision/ Mission framing positions education as formation under a Christian worldview, focused on virtue, wisdom, and the mastery of truth, goodness, and beauty as real ends. - The "Portrait of a Graduate" and related materials articulate character, discipline, and a holy formation as core aims beyond content delivery. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Present positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing (implied via virtuous living and leadership), telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, great conversation.
 - Negative signals: explicit focus on job/workforce prep is not foregrounded; the messaging centers formation and virtue rather than career metrics. Why this rating
 - The school's stated purpose foregrounds formation and virtue as the ends of education, with reality-claims about truth/goodness/beauty and a Christian telos guiding pedagogy. This strongly aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and goal. #### Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence
 - Core emphasis on liberal arts through grammar, logic, and rhetoric (grammar from K–6 with logic in middle school and rhetoric in upper grades). - Explicit Great Books/Great Conversation orientation (Omnibus, integration of history, literature, theology; cycles through Ancient, Medieval, Modern periods; Bible coverage by graduation). - Latin study beginning in 3rd grade and emphasis on Western canon and classical literature (Apostolic Fathers, Plato/Aristotle, The Divine Comedy, Shakespeare, etc.). - History integrated across subjects (Omnibus) and a focus on primary sources and original texts (biblical and classical works listed). - The curriculum explicitly names Omnibus as an integrative study of history, literature, and theology; curriculum cycles through classical time periods; emphasis on great books. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Present positive keywords: liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), great books, great conversation, Latin/Greek, Western civilization, primary sources, Omnibus, Bible/theology as integrated with curricular content.
 - Negative signals: none prominent in public materials (no wholesale replacement by social studies framing; history is treated as Western/canonical history rather than modern social studies alone). Why this rating
 - The school's curriculum explicitly mirrors the Seven Liberal Arts framework, Great Books/Great Conversation, and classical language study, with integrated history and theology. This is a textbook CLASSICAL curriculum signature. #### Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence
 - The presence of capstone rhetoric courses and a Senior Thesis (upper-school) signals a strong rhetorical/argumentative pedagogy. - Upper-school pedagogy includes seminars and debate-like engagement through rhetoric training and thesis defenses. The capstone rhetoric and thesis process is explicit. - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing/recitation and memory work, with a focus on wonder and traditional pedagogy. The site invites visitors to observe classroom singing/recitations during tours. - Omnibus as integrated study suggests cross-disciplinary inquiry and dialectical discussion in practice. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Present positive keywords: Socratic/seminar-style discussion (implied via seminars and debates in rhetoric), recitation/singing, memory work, scholé/contemplative pace, rhetoric, thesis, great conversation.
 - Negative signals: the site does not emphasize purely project-based, student-directed constructivist approaches; rather, it centers on classical methods (recitation, memory, canonical texts). The classical lexicon lists "Socratic seminars" and "recitation" as positive pedagogy in classical forms. Why this rating
 - The combination of capstone rhetoric, senior thesis, grammar-logic-rhetoric progression, and lower-school memory/recitation aligns with historic classical pedagogy. The site's language and examples strongly support a CLASSICAL pedagogy profile. #### Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence

- Public materials emphasize teachers and leaders who model virtue and form the living curriculum (e.g., Portrait of a Graduate language; the school's emphasis on "discipleship" and "leading by example" appears in mission language). - The site features a structured administrative lineup (Headmaster, Upper School Director, Lower School Director, Admissions Director, etc.), signaling a professional, mission-driven faculty framework. - The school describes itself as building a "living curriculum" and a culture of mentorship and virtue through its faculty, aligning with classical faculty ideals. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Present positive keywords: living curriculum, mentor/teacher as exemplar, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, Christian formation, master/teacher archetypes, collegial culture.
- Negative signals: none of the negative signals (e.g., purely credential-driven or non-classical teacher models) appear in the public materials; the focus remains on virtue, mentorship, and classical formation. Why this rating
- The public materials present a faculty model consistent with classical education: teachers as mentors, living curriculum, and a public-facing portrait of teacher ideals, backed by identifiable leadership (Headmaster and directors). This supports CLASSICAL. #### Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and collaboration with parents and the church in forming students, including joint formation, and a biblical worldview. - The site invites parents to visit, attend events, and participate (Open Houses, Shadow Visits, tours, and ongoing communications such as newsletters). - The school actively engages parents as co-educators and provides opportunities for parent formation (e.g., parent outreach, book studies, and classical education education materials on the site). Positive keywords from the classical lexicon align with these signals. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Present positive keywords: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, home-school alignment, family catechesis, parental engagement, classical family culture.
- Negative signals: none of the negative signals (consumeristic parent role, minimal parent involvement) appear in the site copy; the messaging supports robust parental involvement. Why this rating
- The school's messaging positions parents as partners and co-educators in a classical framework, with numerous opportunities for family involvement and parent education, matching CLASSICAL. — ## What Would Move the Needle - No major needle-moving changes are required. Agape Christi Academy (Eden Prairie, MN, 55344) already demonstrates strong CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories: Religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. If anything, future refinements could be to explicitly foreground liturgical practices or chapel rhythms in public copy to strengthen Element 1 signals even further, though current materials already reflect a robust Christian formation and biblical worldview. The presence of well-articulated Great Books/Great Conversation, canonical texts, and a strong upper-school rhetoric/thesis program already anchors the school firmly in classical education. —

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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